

Lab: The Balance Beam

Goal

To test your balance and focus.

What You Need

- Masking tape (or a line on the sidewalk).
- A book (optional).

Steps

1. The Line

Put a long piece of tape on the floor. This is the "Beam." (It's safe because it's on the floor!).

2. The Walk

Walk heel-to-toe across the line. Don't step off! If you step off, you fell into the "Lava."

3. The Challenge

Try walking backward. Try closing one eye. Try balancing a book on your head while you walk.

Discussion

- Which was hardest?
- Did you wave your arms to stay balanced? (That's your body adjusting center of gravity).
- Balance takes constant micro-adjustments by the brain.

What We Learned

Moving beautifully requires a lot of behind-the-scenes work by the brain and body.